

BOBBY CARELSE

Senior Full Stack Engineer | React & React Native | Node.js / NestJS | AWS & Azure
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Full Stack Engineer with 7+ years shipping production systems across fintech, proptech, hospitality, and banking. Runs an independent consultancy, Peregrine Commit, serving multiple concurrent clients — architecting NestJS/Node microservices, Next.js and React front-ends, and React Native mobile apps end-to-end across AWS and Azure. Has rebuilt legacy platforms into modular monorepos, closed security gaps through proper role-based auth design, and used message queues and offline-first local storage to keep sensitive data intact when systems or networks drop. Equally comfortable owning architecture and code quality as leading delivery — scoping work, running agile ceremonies, mentoring developers, and handling client-facing technical decisions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Java

Frontend: React, Next.js, React Native, Redux, Atomic Design, Storybook

Backend: Node.js, NestJS, ASP.NET Core, RabbitMQ, MongoDB

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, RDS, end-to-end infra), Azure, Nginx, GitHub Actions, Bitbucket Pipelines

Architecture: Microservices, Monorepos (Turborepo), Clean Architecture, MVVM, MVC, MVP, offline-first design

Practices: TDD (Jest, Playwright), role-based auth/security design, Agile & Scrum delivery, product scoping, mentoring, Atomic Design, semantic design tokens

EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant — Peregrine Commit (trading name of BobbyCarelse Pty Ltd), Remote

November 2023 – Present

Operate an independent software consultancy delivering senior full-stack and mobile engineering to multiple concurrent clients. Selected engagements:

Juta and Company — Senior Fullstack Developer

- Rebuilt a real-estate contracts platform (post-acquisition) that lets agents list properties and generate full documentation themselves, removing the legal team from routine data-collection work.
- Restructured the codebase into a monorepo, splitting modules into dedicated repos where it made sense, and built a UI kit from the ground up using Atomic Design principles.
- Chose NestJS for the backend specifically for its clean queue-based processing, standing up a dedicated microservice for notifications.

Stack: Next.js (admin portal), NestJS (backend + notifications microservice), React (marketing site), Azure, Storybook, Jest.

Neighbourgood — Senior Fullstack Developer

- Replaced a Strapi backend that broke down under real usage (~3,000 users) with a modular NestJS architecture, splitting services so any module can be pulled into its own repo later.
- Closed a significant security gap by introducing proper auth guards and role-based permissions after discovering nearly all roles had unrestricted access; extended scoped access to influencers and travellers without touching admin-only capability.
- Owned end-to-end product management for the rebuild, running scoped Agile/Scrum delivery solo.

Stack: NestJS, AWS EC2, Nginx, GitHub, GitHub Actions.

Shoprite Group — Senior React Developer

- Built the Money Market app in React Native and TypeScript, letting thousands of users buy prepaid airtime and electricity directly from their phones.
- Designed the state-management and caching strategy for request loading, and implemented offline-first local storage so transactions were captured on-device and synced once connectivity returned.

Stack: React Native, TypeScript, Jest, Playwright.

Relive — Senior React Native Developer (short-term contract covering maternity leave)

- Rebuilt the Relive running and cycling tracking app to properly separate concerns across the codebase.
- Built the UI kit and rolled it out across the app's routes under strictly enforced Clean Architecture and Atomic Design standards.

Stack: React Native, TypeScript, Storybook, Jest, Turborepo.

Tech Lead — Sovtech, Cape Town

February 2023 – March 2024

- Led a 5-developer team delivering a platform for one of the largest POS device and card machine providers, covering device sales, subscription management, and user administration.
- Owned final architecture and technical decisions, and paired directly with developers to unblock them when they were stuck.
- Enforced code review standards and engineering best practices across the team.

Stack: React, Node.js, AWS (hosting, storage, monitoring).

Senior Software Developer — Dimension Data, Cape Town

May 2022 – February 2023

- Contracted via BriteHouse to Prodigy Finance, which finances Ivy League students, to simplify communication and coordination between students and lenders.
- Built a platform to manage student and lender profiles independently while keeping them synced with Prodigy Finance's existing backend systems.
- Introduced RabbitMQ-based messaging to protect student data integrity when systems or connectivity dropped, preventing partial or duplicate submissions.

Stack: NestJS, React, TypeScript, Jest, RabbitMQ.

Senior Software Developer — Sovtech, Cape Town

August 2020 – May 2022

- Led delivery of JamiiPesa, a micro-investment platform enabling Kenyan users to invest small amounts, with all transactions recorded on the blockchain as the system of record.
- Architected JamiiPesa end-to-end — BFF, account services, and user management — integrating deposits and withdrawals through Pesa Pay and programmatically creating currencies and wallets on the blockchain.
- Led development of a gamified education platform for Naspers, rewarding programme students with credits for engagement and progress.
- Owned project scoping after design sign-off, set development standards, and mentored developers on the team; engaged directly with clients on technology decisions and delivery handover as needed.

Stack: AWS (RDS), React, React Native, Node.js, Jest, Bitbucket Pipelines.

Intermediate React Native Developer — Byte Orbit, Cape Town

September 2019 – July 2020

- Worked as one of two native Android developers building the mobile client for Shyft, a forex trading solution developed for Standard Bank.
- Transitioned to React Native within a 3-developer team to build a dating app that matched users for restaurant reservations, revealing who they'd be meeting only on the night.
- Owned the cards management module and the data presentation layer across both projects.

Stack: Java, Android (MVP, Observable-based API requests), React Native.

Junior Software Developer — ABSA (via ImmersionTalent), Cape Town

February 2019 – September 2019

- Built proof-of-concept apps to evaluate the cost and effort of migrating resource-heavy legacy native apps into cross-platform frameworks, presenting trade-off analysis to guide technical direction.
- Sharpened scoping, Agile delivery, and JavaScript fundamentals while strengthening core Java skills in a regulated banking environment.

Junior Software Developer — ImmersionTalent, Cape Town

August 2018 – February 2019

- Built a client booking solution on Android backed by a Node.js and MongoDB service.
- Delivered an MVP for Golden Arrow to track and manage live bus arrival times across the city.
- Built native Android applications in Java and cross-platform apps in React Native, applying MVVM, MVC, and MVP design patterns.

EDUCATION

Matric — Cape Academy of Mathematics, Science and Technology, Cape Town (2017)